opposite of what has come to pass in the post-Partition subcontinent where erstwhile friends are seen as foes. Religion, caste, language and culture have been inducted into a new post-Independence narrative to divide Punjab's unique millenia-long hybridity and cosmopolitan coexistence.

Although little is known of Bhagat Singh as a scribe, he worked as a journalist for popular publications such as *Kirti*, *Arjun* and *Pratap.* In *Kirti*, he wrote two articles in June 1928. The first was called 'On Untouchability' ('Achoot ka Sawaal'). The second was called 'Communal Riots and their Solutions' ('Sampradayik Dange aur unka Ilaj'). As is especially clear from the second article, Bhagat Singh's lure today lies in a telling reminder to the people of how they have once again to 'start believing that we all are born equal and our vocation, as well, need not divide us. If someone is born in a sweeper's family that does not mean that he/she has to continue in the family profession [of] cleaning . . . all his life, with no right to participate in any developmental work'.[4]

In the writings that Bhagat Singh left behind, he emphasized the following: 'As long as the words like black and white, civilized and uncivilized, ruler and the ruled, rich and poor, touchable and untouchable, etc. are in vogue where is the scope for universal brotherhood? This can only be preached by free people. The slave India cannot refer to it.' It was on this basis that he demanded, 'We will have to campaign for equality and equity. Will have to punish those who oppose the creation of such a world.'[5] Amid the failed politics of post-Independence India and Pakistan, these words now resonate with the common man on the street. According to Irfan Habib, the fact that Bhagat Singh commands such reverence in Pakistan now suggests that 'he surely must be more than a territorial nationalist', and in fact 'a nationalist who stood for the freedom of all oppressed communities across the colonised world'. Bhagat Singh warned against the very divisive politics which now plagues the Indian subcontinent—with its divisive news anchors who have scant regard for the truth—as it does much of the democratic world.

In an excoriating critique of the press from mid-1928, a year before he was arrested, he wrote,